

GREEN BEANS *Phaseolus vulgaris*

Call them what you like: snap, string, French, wax, borlotti, cranberry, Kenya, or flageolet, Green beans are delicious eaten when pods are young and fresh, eaten podded like peas, or grown to produce a crop of dry beans. Custom choose your favorite—green beans generally have a bush or climbing habit, and are available in a wide variety of colors, from yellow, gold, and purple to multicolored or traditional green.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Green beans like a sheltered, warm site; frost will kill them, and climbing varieties will need protection from the wind. Dig in well-rotted manure or compost in the fall before sowing. Green beans need a moisture-retentive, fertile soil, but do not usually need nitrogenous fertilizer, since their roots fix and store nitrogen in the soil.

Sow beans any time from early spring onward, depending on the weather in your region. If starting indoors, plant seed in extra-deep multipacks or individual pots, at a depth of 2 in (5 cm). Harden off; plant out when seedlings have reached 3 in (8 cm), and the soil has warmed up. Alternatively, wait until the last frosts have passed,



Sow three seeds to a pot in early spring.

and sow seed directly into the ground at a depth of 2 in (5 cm). Construct bamboo cane supports for climbing varieties, and sow or plant at the bottom of each cane.

CROP CARE

Mulch well around seedlings and water regularly; ensure that plants do not dry out once their flowers appear. Bush varieties will become quite top-heavy, so